WEEKLY TRENDS
FOR THE CULTURED FARMER
ISSUE 2

WHAT ARE WE SEEING AROUND THE WORLD THIS WEEK?

Cottage cheese is still the star.

Cottage cheese keeps trending on TikTok as a protein staple, and India's Milky Mist is now betting its IPO on protein cottage cheese and Greek yoghurt. Protein is getting dearer to make, with whey protein prices at record highs. At home, Apta bought Alba Cheese and the regulator is moving Health Star Ratings toward mandatory.

Alli & Tiff
Eclectic · The Cultured Farmer

Week of 19–25 October 2026

30 DAIRY SIGNALS
6 MARKETS
7 PACK & DESIGN IDEAS

Act on this now

COTTAGE CHEESE · US

Cottage cheese's TikTok protein revival keeps going

The old 'boomer food' is now framed as a protein staple on TikTok, including a viral cottage cheese baking hack.

Why it matters: The demand behind Cotti is still building. Give shoppers the recipes, like the baking hack, so they use more of it.

Tasting Table · Read the story

M&A · AUSTRALIA

Apta Group buys a majority stake in Alba Cheese

The PE-backed dairy group, which also owns Village Dairy Australia and Southern Valley, beat multinational bidders for the Victorian artisanal cheesemaker.

Why it matters: Local dairy is consolidating. A bigger Apta means a better-resourced rival in the cheese and dairy fridge.

Food & Drink Business · Read the story

REGULATION · AUSTRALIA

FSANZ moves toward a mandatory Health Star Rating

The regulator is consulting on a start date for making Health Star Ratings mandatory. They are voluntary today.

Why it matters: Score every Cultured Farmer and Cotti line now. High-protein, low-sugar dairy should score well, so it could become a selling point.

FoodNavigator · Read the story

Protein & cottage cheese

PROTEIN COSTS · FOODCOM DAIRY NEWSLETTER

Whey protein prices hit record highs despite a milk surplus

WPI pricing reached record levels even as raw milk sits in surplus.

Why it matters: Products that get their protein from the milk itself, like cottage cheese, have a cost edge over recipes that add whey.

Foodcom Dairy Newsletter · Read the story

PROTEIN DAIRY · AFAQS!

Milky Mist bets on protein cottage cheese and Greek yoghurt ahead of its IPO

The Tamil Nadu dairy major is launching high-protein milk, Greek yoghurt and protein cottage cheese as its core growth lever, ahead of a planned IPO of about US$245m.

Why it matters: Protein cottage cheese is now a headline growth story for a big dairy company, not a niche line.

afaqs! · Read the story

Yoghurt, skyr & kefir

CULTURES · DAIRYREPORTER

Fermented dairy is Europe's clear favourite fermented food

A 12,646-person study across 53 countries found more than 94% of Europeans eat fermented dairy daily. Plant-based alternatives get high trial but little repeat buying.

Why it matters: Live cultures in real dairy earn repeat purchase. That is The Cultured Farmer's home ground, so say it loudly on pack.

DairyReporter · Read the story

SKYR · ALVINOLOGY

Icelandic skyr brand Ísey debuts in Singapore

A five-flavour range launched in Singapore from S$5.80.

Why it matters: Skyr is moving into Asian markets. That is worth watching for any export plans.

Alvinology · Read the story

YOGHURT · DAIRY INDUSTRIES INTERNATIONAL

The high-protein yoghurt arms race keeps going

Arla, Yoplait and Danone's YoPro are all extending high-protein yoghurt and quark ranges, and Woolworths is pushing a protein Greek-style own-brand line.

Why it matters: Protein alone won't stand out for long. Lead with cultures, texture and taste.

Dairy Industries International · Read the story

Retail & rules

AUSTRALIA · DAIRY NEWS TODAY

Woolworths to phase out Farmers' Own milk by mid-2027

A shift in Woolworths' home-brand milk strategy. The exact announcement date is unconfirmed.

Why it matters: A range change in the dairy fridge is a reason to get in front of the buyer early.

Dairy News Today · Read the story

EREWHON · MALK ORGANICS

Erewhon's Easy Tiger smoothie puts Greek yoghurt and whey in the cup

Megan Moroney's US$22 smoothie layers Stonyfield Greek yoghurt and A2 whey protein with creatine, electrolytes and manuka honey.

Why it matters: Cultured dairy is now part of the viral café drink story. A named Cultured Farmer yoghurt in an Australian café collab could earn the same free reach.

MALK Organics · Read the story

Pay homage to: pack & design

CHEESE PACK · THE DIELINE

Kraft shrinks its parmesan shaker into a 'Pocket Parm' bag charm

A tiny clip-on version of the green shaker bottle, sold with a collectible charm in three new flavours.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it with a mini, on-the-go Cotti format that people want to carry and show off.

The Dieline · Read the story

YOGHURT CONCEPT · THE DIELINE

'Milky Band' concept turns yoghurt caps into toy animals

Each bottle gets a bear, kitten or frog cap with soft, wobbly lettering, so the pack becomes the toy. It is a concept, not on shelf.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it in a kids' drinking yoghurt: a collectible cap gives a reason to buy the next one.

The Dieline · Read the story

DAIRY DESSERT · PACKAGING OF THE WORLD

YUM Proteic Creme brings playful illustration to a protein dessert

Bold illustration and colour make a protein creme dessert look like a treat rather than a supplement.

How we'd use it: Pay homage to it on a protein dessert pot: lead with indulgence on pack and let the protein number sit second.

Packaging of the World · Read the story

Opportunity of the week

7
/10

Live Cottage: kefir-cultured cottage cheese

$5.50 · 350g

Cottage cheese made with live kefir cultures, so you get protein and gut health in one tub. Plain 4% and 0%, plus Chive and Lemon, pitched at the TikTok cottage cheese crowd who use it in wraps, bakes and bowls.

Australian cottage cheese volumes are up more than 40% and Arla has bought Brancourts, so the plain tub will become a price fight. Biotiful only launches the UK's first kefir cottage cheese in December, so a live-culture Cotti could be first here.

Pack idea: A clear-window tub that shows the curd, with a 'live' bubble motif and recipe QR codes under the lid.

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Want us to go deeper on any of these? Reply and we'll run a full category brief.

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Do the homework, then commit and go hard.

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